

Chapter 3

Worksheet

Instructions:

Please complete all activities in this worksheet. Write your answers in the spaces provided or on separate sheets if needed.

Chapter 3: Idea Generation and Validation Worksheet

Instructions: Complete each section below over the course of a week or as assigned by your teacher/mentor. Use the detailed steps from Chapter 3 to guide your thinking. Be creative, honest, and detailed in your responses. This worksheet will help you develop and validate one side hustle idea from start to finish. Feel free to doodle or add sticky notes for extra ideas!

Part 1: Creative Brainstorming Techniques

Goal: Generate a variety of side hustle ideas without judgment.

- **Mind Mapping Exercise (10 minutes):**

- In the space below, draw a small mind map starting with a central theme (e.g., “Side Hustle Ideas” or “Things I’m Good At”). Create at least 3 main branches with related categories and 2-3 sub-branches for each with specific ideas. Use colours or symbols if you’d like!
- **Central Theme:** _____
- (Draw or describe your mind map here)

- **List Your Top Ideas:**

- From your mind map or a quick brainstorming session, write down your top 5 side hustle ideas. Don’t overthink—just list what excites you most!

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- **Reflection:** Which of these ideas feels most exciting to you and why? (2-3 sentences)

Part 2: Solving Problems in Your Community

Goal: Identify a real problem your side hustle could solve.

- **Problem Spotting:**

- Over the next 2-3 days, observe your school, neighborhood, or online spaces. List 3 problems or frustrations you notice or hear about.

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- **Solution Brainstorm:**

- For each problem, write one possible side hustle solution.

- Problem 1 Solution: _____

- Problem 2 Solution: _____

- Problem 3 Solution: _____

- **Pick Your Focus:**

- Choose one problem-solution pair to combine with your brainstorming ideas (or pick a new idea inspired by this). Write it here as your "Chosen Side Hustle Idea" for the rest of the worksheet.

- **Chosen Idea:** _____

- **Problem It Solves:** _____

Part 3: Researching Your Idea

Goal: Test if there's demand for your idea by gathering feedback.

- **Mini-Survey Creation:**

- Write 3 short questions to ask peers, family, or friends about your chosen idea (e.g., "Would you buy this?", "How much would you pay?", "What would make it better?").

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- **Feedback Collection Plan:**

- How will you get responses? (e.g., Instagram poll, group chat, in-person at lunch)
- Goal: Get feedback from at least 10 people. List who you'll ask or where you'll post.

- **Results Summary (Fill in after collecting feedback):**

- What did most people say? (e.g., "8/10 would buy it at \$5")
- What's one change or improvement you could make based on feedback?

Part 4: Competitor Analysis for Teens

Goal: Learn from others doing similar things and find your unique angle.

- **Competitor Search:**

- Search online (Google, Instagram, TikTok, etc.) or locally for 3 people/businesses with a similar idea to yours. List them below with a quick note on what they offer and their price (if available).

- Name/Business: _____

- What they offer & price: _____

- Name/Business: _____

- What they offer & price: _____

- Name/Business: _____

- What they offer & price: _____

- **Strengths & Weaknesses:**

- Pick one competitor. Write one thing they do well and one thing they could improve.

- Strength: _____
- Weakness: _____

- **Your Unique Angle:**

- How will your idea stand out from competitors? (e.g., lower price, cooler designs, targeting a specific group)

Part 5: Feasibility Check: Can You Do It?

Goal: Assess if you can realistically start this hustle with your current time, resources, and skills.

- **Feasibility Scorecard:** Rate each category from 1-5 (1 = "No way," 5 = "Totally got this").

- **Time:** How many hours can I commit weekly? Do I have enough? Rating: ____ /5 Notes (e.g., "I have 5 hours after school"): _____
- **Resources:** Do I have or can I get the money/tools/space needed? Rating: ____ /5 Notes (e.g., "Need \$20 for supplies"): _____
- **Skills:** Do I know how to do this, or can I learn quickly? Rating: ____ /5 Notes (e.g., "Need to watch YouTube tutorials"): _____
- **Support:** Do I have friends/family to help if needed? Rating: ____ /5 Notes (e.g., "Mom can help with transport"): _____
- **Total Score:** ____ /20 (16-20 = Go for it! 10-15 = Tweak it. Below 10 = Rethink.)

- **Adjustments if Needed:**

- If your score is below 16, how can you tweak your idea to make it more doable? (e.g., start smaller, find a partner)

Final Reflection & Next Steps

Goal: Summarize your learning and plan your next move.

- **What I Learned:** Write 2-3 sentences about the biggest takeaway from this process. Did anything surprise you?
- **My Commitment:** Will you move forward with this idea? Why or why not? If yes, what's your first action step in the next week? (e.g., buy supplies, make a sample product)
- **Share Your Idea:** (Optional) Write a short "pitch" (2-3 sentences) for your side hustle to share with a friend, family member, or teacher for feedback.